

Facilitator Guide

AIM ASEAN Programme: AI for MSME
Advancement in ASEAN

Curriculum Designed and Developed by:
AIM ASEAN Programme

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Introduction

It is a pleasure to work with you on this exciting journey! To kickstart this collaboration journey, we have created this **Facilitator Guide** to assist your local implementation of the AIM ASEAN Program. It includes descriptions of the modules, highlighting their importance to a business owner's AI adoption journey.

There is a [Resource Hub](#) that we are building to raise your effectiveness in meaningful programs on equipping business owners with the knowledge and skills to embark on the AI adoption journey.

Our goal is to empower you, our local implementation partner, with the knowledge and narrative you need to effectively transfer this knowledge and customize the learning materials for the communities you serve in the AIM ASEAN program.

The shared curriculum outline will form the backbone to assist business owners in the different ASEAN countries to understand and adopt AI into their business. In this journey, our Local Implementation Partners will play an important role in ensuring that the foundational knowledge needed to adopt Artificial Intelligence effectively and efficiently with manageable risk gets transferred over to the business owners. This will spur the economic and job growth of ASEAN, a desired outcome of [ASEAN Foundation](#), [Google.org](#) and [AVPN](#).

The Facilitator Guide will be categorised by module for ease of use and structured delivery. For each module, there will be a **clear rationale** explaining its purpose and relevance in the AI adoption journey. To support interactive learning (except for optional modules), **suggested thought-provoking questions** are included to spark discussions among participants. Where relevant, **curated YouTube videos** are provided as references to illustrate concepts and use cases visually. **Supplementary materials** (except for optional modules) related to each module are also provided to reinforce understanding and provide additional context.

For guidance on the suggested duration of each module, including topics and subtopics, facilitators may refer to the official detailed curriculum, which serves as a reference framework to help plan and customise sessions according to the needs of local participants.

Module 1: AI Fundamentals - The Basics and Use Cases

Why this Module

We have designed Module 1 as the essential entry point for the entire curriculum, as it revises briefly on the foundational understanding that business owners need before spending more time diving into the use cases. This will allow the business owner to discover their own use cases after the program. We start by making it accessible, addressing any initial intimidation or misconceptions, and setting the same page.

In this module, the key points to cover are the core concepts of AI and its practical business applications. And especially the business applications, the focus of the program is to motivate business owners to start looking at and adopt AI effectively and efficiently into their businesses.

You will revise what AI is in simple, non-technical terms and then introduce the main types of AI, like Machine Learning and Generative AI, with clear, relatable examples. This will allow our participants to distinguish between different technologies. We will also articulate the five compelling business reasons for AI adoption. These points are vital because they provide the "why", the tangible benefits that will capture a business owner's interest and motivate them to see AI as a solution, not just a buzzword.

Finally, you will guide them to identify potential areas within their businesses where AI could create significant value, making the learning immediately actionable and relevant through the use cases you adopted, customised to the local circumstances.

Thought-provoking Questions (For Discussion)

1. Many people believe AI is only for large corporations. Is that true? What is a specific, simple task in your current business that you believe could be automated by AI, and what a specific positive impact this would have on your business?
2. Thinking about the different types of AI, which one do you think holds the most immediate potential for your business and why? Which type do you think is a long-term goal?
3. Based on the misconceptions about AI, which one have you personally held, and what about your business operations might have led you to believe it?
4. Think about the most time-consuming, repetitive task in your business that currently requires a human. If you could automate just one part of that process with AI, which part would it be and how would it free up your team to focus on higher-value work?
5. Imagine your most frequent customer complaint or challenge. How could AI be used to predict or even prevent this problem from happening in the first place, thus enhancing the customer experience?

6. Looking at your business's strategic goals for the next three to five years, where do you see the greatest opportunity for AI to act as a "competitive advantage" rather than just a cost-saving tool?

Suggested Quiz (Individual Assignment)

Question 1: What is the primary business reason for adopting AI?

- A. To replace all human employees with robots.
- B. To avoid making any difficult decisions.
- C. To improve customer experience and make data-driven decisions.
- D. To cut costs by eliminating the marketing department.

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: AI enables companies to analyze large amounts of data to gain insights for better decision-making and personalize customer interactions, leading to enhanced experiences and satisfaction.

Question 2: A business owner wants to automate customer support inquiries with a tool that can understand and respond to customer questions in natural language. Which type of AI would be most suitable?

- A. Computer Vision
- B. Natural Language Processing (NLP)
- C. Generative AI
- D. Robotic Process Automation (RPA)

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: NLP is a type of AI that is designed to understand, interpret, and generate human language. It is the foundation for tools like chatbots and virtual assistants used in customer service.

Question 3: A manufacturing company wants to use AI to automatically inspect products on an assembly line for defects. Which type of AI would be the best fit for this task?

- A. Natural Language Processing

- B. Predictive Analytics
- C. Supervised Learning
- D. Computer Vision

Correct Answer: D

Explanation: Computer Vision is the type of AI that allows computers to "see" and interpret visual information, making it ideal for tasks like quality control in manufacturing and facial recognition.

Question 4: Your company's marketing team wants to use AI to create personalized product descriptions for your online store. What type of AI would enable this?

- A. Computer Vision
- B. Supervised Machine Learning
- C. Generative AI
- D. Predictive Analytics

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: Generative AI creates new content, such as text, images, or code. It is useful for content creation, design, and personalized marketing messages.

Question 5: A business owner wants to predict future sales trends based on past performance data. Which type of AI is used for this purpose?

- A. Generative AI
- B. Natural Language Processing
- C. Computer Vision
- D. Machine Learning

Correct Answer: D

Explanation: Machine Learning is a type of AI that learns from data without explicit programming. It can be used for tasks like fraud detection and recommendation engines, as well as for making predictions based on historical data.

Question 6: Which of these is a key benefit of using AI in business operations?

- A. Eliminating the need for any human oversight.
- B. Predictive maintenance to prevent equipment failures.
- C. Removing all risk from business decisions.
- D. Instantly solving all company-wide problems.

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: AI can be used in operations and supply chain management for tasks like predictive maintenance, which helps to optimize equipment performance and prevent costly downtime.

Question 7: Your business is using an AI-powered tool that recommends products to customers based on their past purchases. What kind of AI is this an example of?

- A. Supervised Machine Learning
- B. Unsupervised Learning
- C. Reinforcement Learning
- D. Generative AI

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: The module describes supervised learning as a type of Machine Learning that uses labeled data. In this case, the past purchase data is used as the labeled data to train the AI to make recommendations.

Question 8: You are a business owner trying to decide where to apply AI in your company. According to the curriculum, which of these is a common business use case for AI?

- A. Building a new headquarters.
- B. Automating financial reconciliation and risk assessment.
- C. Hiring all new employees.
- D. Creating a new company logo.

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: The curriculum outlines common AI use cases across different business functions, including finance and accounting, where AI can be used for fraud detection, risk assessment, and automated reconciliation.

Question 9: What is the most common and fundamental reason for business owners to consider adopting AI in their company?

- A. To completely eliminate all staff roles and save money on salaries.
- B. To automate manual tasks, improve efficiency, and make better decisions using data.
- C. To gain access to a larger pool of potential investors.
- D. To replace existing technology with the newest, most expensive systems available.

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: AI's primary value to businesses lies in its ability to automate repetitive tasks, which frees up employees to focus on more strategic work. It also uses data to provide insights that lead to better, more informed decision-making.

Question 10: What is the primary benefit of using AI for a business's sales and marketing team?

- A. It helps in creating personalized marketing campaigns and predicting customer behavior.
- B. It allows them to avoid interacting with customers directly.
- C. It ensures that every product or service is sold at the highest possible price.
- D. It guarantees that all new product launches will be successful.

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: AI can analyze large datasets to identify patterns in customer behavior, which allows for the creation of highly personalized marketing campaigns and accurate sales forecasts.

Question 11: Which of the following is an example of AI's use in a company's financial department?

- A. Using AI to detect fraudulent transactions and automate financial reporting.

- B. Using AI to choose the company's next CEO.
- C. Automating the process of managing employee vacation requests.
- D. Developing a new marketing slogan with AI.

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: In finance, AI is widely used for fraud detection by analyzing transaction patterns. It can also automate the tedious process of financial reporting, making it faster and more accurate.

Curated YouTube Videos

1. **Title:** Gemini in Workspace | 2025 Guide for Business Owners
Channel: itGenius 🧐 Biz Tech Experts

This YouTube video is a guide for business owners on how to use Google Gemini AI within the Google Workspace. The presenter, Pete Morotti, shares his experiences and highlights the best functional features.

A business owner should watch this video to learn how to increase productivity by automating tasks, improve data analysis, and gain strategic insights by leveraging the collective knowledge stored in their Google Workspace.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DPmROlytF7s>.

2. **Title:** Google's AI Course for Beginners (in 10 minutes)!
Channel: Jeff Su

This video provides a concise, 10-minute overview of Google's 4-hour AI course for beginners. It clarifies the relationships between Artificial Intelligence (AI), Machine Learning (ML), and Deep Learning, and explains different types of models within these fields, including supervised and unsupervised learning, as well as generative AI.

A business owner should watch this video because it demystifies AI and its related concepts, providing a foundational understanding to help them make informed decisions about adopting AI tools. It can also help them identify potential AI applications within their business and understand the role of data.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yq0QkCxoTHM>.

3. **Title:** What is Machine Learning?
Channel: Google Cloud Tech

This video provides a high-level overview of machine learning (ML), defining it as the process of using data to create models that can answer questions and make predictions. It explains that ML is a powerful way to leverage the immense amount of data now available. The video breaks down the process into two key stages: training, where a model learns from existing data, and inference, where the trained model is used to make predictions on new data. It also provides examples of ML applications across various industries, from image recognition and fraud detection to personalized recommendations and healthcare.

A business owner should watch this video to understand the fundamental concepts of machine learning and its potential applications. It highlights how ML can be used to make processes "better, faster, and easier" and is becoming a standard expectation for modern products. By understanding how ML works, a business owner can identify opportunities to leverage their own data to gain valuable insights, personalize customer experiences, and drive innovation.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HcgpanDadyQ>.

4. **Title:** AI Explained to Business Owners
Channel: Allie Bloyd

This video explains how Artificial Intelligence (AI) can revolutionize small businesses by automating tasks, improving marketing, and enabling scaling without a large team.

A business owner should watch this video to learn how to save time and reduce overwhelm, improve marketing effectiveness, and scale their business without needing a large team.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=R8Y47TU-s3o>

5. **Title:** The 3 types of AI explained in 2 minutes
Channel: Future with Fawzi

This video provides a concise overview of the different types of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and their capabilities. It explains the difference between traditional machines and AI, uses the "black box" analogy, and breaks down the three types of AI based on their output: predictive, generative, and agentic. It also touches on the levels of AI intelligence, from Narrow AI to the theoretical Artificial General Intelligence (AGI) and Artificial Superintelligence (ASI).

A business owner should watch this video to gain a basic understanding of AI, which can help them identify opportunities to apply these technologies to their specific operations, set realistic expectations, and stay competitive.

The video can be found at http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ukv7nXZ_knY.

6. **Title:** How AI Could Empower Any Business | Andrew Ng | TED
Channel: TED

This video discusses how AI can empower businesses of all sizes, challenging the idea that it's only for large tech companies. It highlights that new, user-friendly AI platforms are making it possible for individuals with specific domain knowledge—like a pizzeria owner or a t-shirt maker—to build custom AI solutions for their unique business needs. This democratization of AI allows small businesses to improve efficiency through tasks like demand forecasting and quality control, ultimately helping them gain a competitive edge.

A business owner should watch this video to understand that AI is becoming more accessible and is not just for large corporations. It serves as an inspiration for how they can apply AI to their own specific business challenges, without needing to be a tech expert. The video encourages thinking about how to leverage new, user-friendly AI platforms to improve efficiency, increase revenue, and innovate within their niche, offering a glimpse into a future where AI empowers every business.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=reUZRYXxUs4>.

7. **Title:** AI for Business: A (non-technical) introduction
Channel: Shaw Talebi

This video provides a non-technical introduction to Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Machine Learning (ML), explaining how these technologies can be applied in a business context. It defines AI, introduces the concept of models, and explains Machine Learning. The video also provides five rules of thumb for using AI in business, such as focusing on problems, applying AI to repetitive tasks, and starting simple.

A business owner should watch this video because it demystifies AI and ML, provides a practical framework for implementation, and helps them make value-driven decisions about adopting AI solutions.

The video can be found at http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8z-WPpP1_-8.

8. **Title:** How AI Image Generators Work (Stable Diffusion / Dall-E) - Computerphile
Channel: Computerphile

This video explains how AI image generators like DALL-E, Imagen, and Stable Diffusion work, focusing on the concept of diffusion models. It contrasts them with older methods like Generative Adversarial Networks (GANs) and breaks down the process into two key phases: a "forward" diffusion process where noise is added to an image, and a "reverse" denoising

process where a neural network is trained to remove that noise. The video also covers how text prompts are used to guide the image generation and a technique called "classifier-free guidance" to improve the alignment between the prompt and the final image.

A business owner should watch this video to gain a foundational understanding of a transformative technology. This knowledge can help them make informed decisions about using AI image tools, identify creative opportunities for marketing and design, set realistic expectations for what these tools can achieve, and stay ahead of the curve in a rapidly evolving technological landscape.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1ClpzeNxIhU>.

9. **Title:** Reinforcement Learning: Crash Course AI #9
Channel: CrashCourse

This video explains reinforcement learning, a type of AI learning where an AI learns by doing and receiving rewards for achieving goals. It breaks down key concepts like the agent, environment, state, actions, and rewards. It also covers the balance between exploitation and exploration and how deep reinforcement learning is used for complex tasks.

A business owner should watch this video to understand a powerful type of AI that is good at solving complex problems. This knowledge can help them identify potential opportunities for automation and innovation within their business and provide a fresh perspective on strategic decision-making.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nlgIv4IfJ6s>.

10. **Title:** Large Language Models explained briefly
Channel: 3Blue1Brown

This video explains how large language models (LLMs) work by breaking down the core concepts. It covers how LLMs predict the next word in a piece of text, the immense training process they undergo on vast amounts of data, and the role of key innovations like the Transformer model and the "attention" mechanism. It also touches on how human feedback is used to refine the models.

A business owner should watch this video to gain a foundational understanding of the technology behind tools like chatbots and content generators. This knowledge can help them make informed decisions about adopting AI, understand the capabilities and limitations of these tools, and identify potential opportunities for innovation in their business.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LPZh9BOjkQs>.

11. **Title:** The Step-by-Step master class on Writing Better Prompts Than 99% of People

Channel: Enovair

This video is a masterclass on prompt engineering, teaching users how to get better and more reliable results from AI tools like ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini. It introduces a six-part prompting framework that helps guide the AI to the exact output you want. The video also shares several advanced "hacks" like a "Truth Detector" to check AI's confidence and a "self-improvement loop" to have the AI critique and rewrite its own work.

A business owner should watch this video to improve the efficiency and quality of AI outputs for tasks like content creation and strategy. By learning to write better prompts, they can reduce errors, gain better strategic insights, and save time on editing. This empowers business owners to unlock AI's true potential and gain a competitive edge.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FxP1O6Q07Go>.

12. Title: Prompting tips to personalize your learning | AI for Students | Google Channel:
Google Career Certificates

This video explains how students can use AI tools like Gemini to personalize their learning experience by using effective prompts. It outlines a five-part framework for creating a strong prompt: Persona (the role you want the AI to play), Task (what you want the AI to do), Format (how you want the information delivered), Context (background information), and References (examples). The video also demonstrates features like prompt chaining for follow-up questions and using voice commands for a conversational experience.

A business owner should watch this video because the principles of effective prompting are highly transferable to business applications. Mastering the art of communicating with an AI can help a business owner generate better marketing content, analyze complex data, draft business plans, and streamline various tasks. The video's focus on tailoring AI output, information verification, and problem-solving techniques can be adapted to improve efficiency and decision-making within a business.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NbHFRA8uMDY>.

13. Title: AI, Machine Learning, Deep Learning and Generative AI Explained
Channel: IBM Technology

This video explains the relationships between Artificial Intelligence (AI), Machine Learning (ML), Deep Learning, and Generative AI. It defines AI as the broad field of simulating human intelligence, ML as a subset where machines learn from data, and Deep Learning as a subset of ML using neural networks. The video also covers Generative AI as the newest advancement focused on creating new content using foundation models and Large Language Models (LLMs).

A business owner should watch this video to understand the different facets of AI and how they relate to each other. This knowledge is crucial for identifying opportunities to use these

technologies in their business, making informed decisions about AI adoption and investment, and recognizing potential risks and benefits.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qYNweeDHiyU>.

- 14. Title:** The ULTIMATE 2025 Guide to Prompt Engineering - Master the Perfect Prompt Formula!
Channel: AI Master

This video is a comprehensive guide to prompt engineering for both language models like ChatGPT and image generators. For language models, it offers tips on being direct, precise, using role-play, setting limitations, and employing "Chain of Thought" prompting. For image generators, it recommends a framework of Subject, Description, and Style, and also covers "negative prompting" to filter out unwanted elements.

A business owner should watch this video because mastering prompt engineering can significantly enhance productivity and content creation. By learning how to communicate effectively with AI, they can generate higher-quality marketing copy and visuals, streamline complex tasks, and ultimately save time and resources.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=blxbplwYTXI>.

- 15. Title:** AI Tools for Small Business - 7 Ways Small Business Can Use AI Today
Channel: Philip VanDusen

This video explains seven ways small businesses can use Artificial Intelligence (AI) to enhance their operations and gain a competitive edge. It emphasizes that AI can level the playing field for small businesses by providing tools for smarter branding, marketing, and overall strategy.

A business owner should watch this video because it provides actionable insights and specific tool recommendations on how to leverage AI to make data-driven decisions, improve efficiency, and gain a competitive advantage.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-y4swMaeJel>.

- 16. Title:** AI in E-Commerce: Real Use Cases in Product Discovery and Personalization
Channel: Darkroom

This video is a panel discussion about the impact of AI on e-commerce, featuring founders of companies specializing in AI-driven solutions for brands. It highlights common mistakes brands make in the customer journey and discusses how AI can enable hyper-personalization at scale. The video also explores tactical AI use cases for ad optimization, conversational commerce, and dynamic landing pages, while also looking ahead to how shopping behaviors are shifting with the rise of Large Language Models (LLMs).

A business owner, especially in e-commerce, should watch this video to gain insights into common pitfalls, learn about actionable AI solutions, and prepare for future shifts in consumer behavior. The discussion provides practical examples and forward-looking perspectives from founders who are actively building these AI solutions, making it a valuable resource for staying competitive.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=y6swJVb6e3U>.

17. Title: How AI Is Reshaping Customer Service Experiences

Channel: Knowledge at Wharton

This video discusses the impact of artificial intelligence (AI) on customer service. It covers the challenge of customer service, AI's initial promise versus the reality of cost-quality trade-offs, the continued need for a human element, and rising customer expectations. It also highlights AI's strengths in overcoming language barriers and its persuasive nature.

A business owner should watch this video to gain a realistic perspective on integrating AI into customer service. It helps them think strategically about their goals (cost-cutting vs. improving experience), manage expectations about AI's capabilities, and understand the complexities of hybrid human-AI workflows for future planning.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wWCEVkvBTYQ>.

18. Title: Can artificial intelligence help make farming profitable in India? | BBC News India

Channel: BBC News India

This video explores how artificial intelligence (AI) is being used to address challenges faced by Indian farmers. It showcases AI-powered devices with sensors that collect data to provide farmers with actionable guidance on when to water, fertilize, or tackle pests, leading to a 20-25% increase in production and a 50% saving in water and chemical costs. The video also discusses the challenges of AI adoption, such as the need for extensive data and low usage rates.

A business owner should watch this video to identify market opportunities in AgriTech, see concrete examples of AI's potential for efficiency and cost savings, and understand the challenges and complexities of scaling such solutions in a developing market.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KyOKIMvYKQs>.

19. Title: AI in supply chain and logistics | Artificial Intelligence in supply chain management

Channel: 10 Min For Supply Chain

This video explains how Artificial Intelligence (AI) is transforming supply chain management. It highlights that AI can improve decision-making, forecasting accuracy, logistics, and reduce

operational costs. The video provides examples of key AI applications such as demand forecasting, inventory management, logistics and transportation optimization, supplier relationship management, and quality control.

A business owner should watch this video to understand the significant benefits AI can bring to their supply chain operations. It provides concrete examples of how major companies are leveraging AI to reduce costs, improve efficiency, enhance decision-making, and minimize disruptions. The video also prepares them for the potential challenges involved in AI adoption.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JfjpFJxljeQ>.

20. Title: How GenAI-Based Software Is Advancing Marketing and Sales
Channel: a16z

This video discusses the impact of generative AI (GenAI) on the marketing and sales industries. It highlights how Large Language Models (LLMs) can be used for content creation, research, and hyper-personalization. The video also discusses the evolution of marketing roles from "doers" to "reviewers" and the shift from "co-pilots" that assist humans to "agents" that perform end-to-end tasks, which is particularly beneficial for small and medium-sized businesses.

A business owner should watch this video to understand how GenAI can enhance their marketing and sales efforts. It provides insights into how AI tools can improve efficiency and save costs, provide deeper customer insights, enable hyper-personalized campaigns, and help them stay competitive in a rapidly evolving landscape.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XjGFurGmh4g>.

21. Title: Generative AI: Top 5 Use Cases for Finance Professionals
Channel: Aaron Dunn

This video highlights five top use cases of generative AI for finance professionals: text summarization of lengthy documents, a document Q&A feature for a knowledge base, data analysis for forecasting and modeling, report generation, and professional development as an interactive tutor.

A business owner should watch this video to learn how generative AI can improve efficiency, decision-making, and skill development within their finance operations. By understanding these use cases, business owners can identify opportunities to save time and resources, enhance data-driven decisions, and upskill their finance team.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hnsL0LV2k20>.

22. Title: Reviewing the Best AI Tools for HR
Channel: HR Party of One

This video discusses several AI tools that can assist HR professionals in their roles. It highlights how tools like Chat GPT can act as a virtual assistant for writing tasks, Grammarly can improve communication quality, Brightmine can help with compliance and labor laws, and Fireflies.ai can automate meeting note-taking.

A business owner should watch this video because it provides insights into how AI can modernize HR functions, save time, improve communication, and mitigate compliance risks. It also addresses crucial considerations such as data privacy, accuracy, and ethical concerns, which are vital for responsible implementation.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sfrBvPKwuVU>.

Supplementary Materials

[<Use Case Feasibility Checklist>](#)

[<AI Prompt Library>](#)

[<AI Prompt Design Worksheet>](#)

[<AI Use Cases>](#)

[<Market Overview Research Report: 10 ASEAN States>](#)

Module 2: The AI Adoption Journey - Steps for Business Owners

Why this Module

"The AI Adoption Journey" serves as the critical transition from understanding AI to planning its implementation. It is strategically placed after the fundamentals so that business owners have a clear, actionable roadmap. The module tackles the "How" after Module 1 tackles the "Why". The goal here is to guide partners in teaching a structured approach to AI, which is vital for minimizing risk and maximizing success.

In this module, you will walk business owners through the key phases of the AI journey. This includes the initial Discovery and Planning to define a specific business problem, followed by Assessment, which assesses the data and tools.

Moving to Piloting, where they will learn to test a solution on a small, controlled scale. This is important because it allows for a low-risk environment to prove value before moving to Scalability, where the solution is expanded across the business. Crucially, you will emphasize the importance of stakeholder engagement and defining success metrics from the start. If it cannot be measured, it never matters. Thus, performance metrics are important; this needs to be stressed in the module. These points are essential for securing buy-in and measuring the project's real-world impact, turning an AI idea into a successful, value-driven business asset.

Thought-provoking Questions

1. Imagine your data readiness assessment reveals that your data is incomplete and messy. Rather than abandoning the AI project, what are three specific, low-cost actions you could take to improve the quality of your data and still move forward with your plan?
2. If you were to choose between a pre-built, off-the-shelf AI tool and partnering with a vendor for a custom solution, what is the single most important factor that would drive your decision for your business? Is it cost, control, or something else entirely?
3. A pilot project is meant to be a learning experience. If your pilot project fails to achieve its initial goals, how would you define "success" in that failure, and what are the most valuable lessons you could extract from the experience to inform your next steps?

Suggested Quiz (Individual Assignment)

Question 1: Before a business owner can successfully implement AI, what is the most critical first step they should take?

A. Hire a large team of AI specialists.

- B. Purchase the most expensive AI software on the market.
- C. Clearly define the business problem they want to solve with AI.
- D. Immediately start collecting as much data as possible without a plan.

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: The first and most crucial step in any AI adoption journey is to define the specific business problem. Without a clear problem, the project lacks direction and a measurable goal, making success difficult to achieve.

Question 2: When a business owner is in the "Identify Opportunities" phase of AI adoption, what is a key question they should be asking?

- A. How many new servers will we need to buy?
- B. What is the most expensive AI model we can afford?
- C. How will this AI solution provide a return on investment (ROI)?
- D. What is the name of the most famous AI scientist?

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: The "Identify Opportunities" phase is about strategic thinking. A key question is to assess the potential ROI to ensure the AI project aligns with business goals and is a worthwhile investment.

Question 3: What does it mean to "pilot" an AI solution?

- A. To launch the AI solution to the entire company all at once.
- B. To use a small, controlled, and limited test to evaluate the solution's effectiveness and address issues.
- C. To train all employees on how to become AI experts.
- D. To outsource the entire project to an external consultant.

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: A pilot is a crucial step that involves a limited rollout of the AI solution. This allows the business to test its functionality, measure its impact, and make necessary adjustments before a full-scale deployment, which minimizes risk.

Question 4: What is the "Scale & Integrate" phase of the AI adoption journey primarily concerned with?

- A. Making the AI solution larger and more expensive.
- B. Expanding the AI solution to new areas or departments of the business.
- C. Reducing the size and scope of the project.
- D. Finding a new business problem for the AI to solve.

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Scalability involves taking a successful pilot project and expanding its use to a broader audience or new areas of the business. This maximizes the value of the initial investment.

Question 5: What is the primary reason to establish a "data readiness" before implementing AI?

- A. To guarantee that the AI system will be able to find and use high-quality, relevant data.
- B. To ensure all company data is stored on a single, old computer.
- C. To increase the complexity of the data for a challenge.
- D. To reduce the amount of data available for the AI to learn from.

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: AI models are only as good as the data they are trained on. A solid data foundation ensures that the data is clean, organized, and accessible, which is critical for the AI to function correctly and provide accurate results.

Question 6: When is the best time for a business owner to communicate the plan to adopt AI to their employees?

- A. Only after the AI system is fully implemented and running.

- B. Never, as it might create unnecessary fear or resistance.
- C. The day before the AI system is launched.
- D. As early as possible to address concerns, manage expectations, and encourage buy-in.

Correct Answer: D

Explanation: Early and transparent communication is key to managing change. It helps to alleviate employee fears about job security, explains the benefits of the new system, and prepares them for the upcoming changes, increasing the likelihood of a smooth transition.

Question 7: A business owner is concerned that an AI project is not delivering the expected results. What should they do first?

- A. Re-evaluate the project goals and data to understand what might be causing the issue.
- B. Immediately abandon the project and start a new one.
- C. Fire the entire project team.
- D. Increase the budget without further analysis.

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: If an AI project isn't meeting expectations, the first step is to perform a root cause analysis. This involves revisiting the initial goals and examining the data and model to identify and correct the problem.

Question 8: What does it mean to "iterate" in the context of AI development?

- A. To build the entire AI model from scratch every time it fails.
- B. To continuously refine and improve the AI model based on feedback and new data.
- C. To only use the AI model once and never again.
- D. To make the AI model less complex over time.

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Iteration is a fundamental concept in AI development. It involves a cycle of building, testing, and refining the model to improve its performance and ensure it meets the desired outcomes.

Question 9: Why is it important to define success metrics for an AI project before it starts?

- A. To ensure the project never ends.
- B. To provide a clear way to measure the project's performance and value. C. To make the project sound more professional to investors.
- C. To make the project sound more professional to investors.
- D. To scare the project team into working faster.

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Defining success metrics (e.g., increased sales, reduced costs, faster processes) at the beginning of a project provides a clear benchmark to evaluate its impact and determine if it has achieved its goals.

Question 10: Which of the following is a common risk associated with the AI adoption journey?

- A. The AI will become sentient and take over the company.
- B. The project might not be successful due to poor data quality or a lack of clear goals.
- C. The project will be too successful and put the company out of business.
- D. The company will run out of electricity to power the AI.

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Common risks in AI projects include poor data quality, an unclear problem statement, and a lack of skilled personnel. These factors can lead to project failure or underperformance.

Question 11: When considering a phased rollout of an AI solution, what is the main advantage?

- A. It is more expensive and time-consuming.
- B. It prevents employees from using the new system.

C. It ensures that the AI solution will fail.

D. It allows the business to learn from each phase, mitigate risks, and gain confidence before a full-scale launch.

Correct Answer: D

Explanation: A phased rollout, often starting with a pilot, allows the company to test and refine the AI solution in a controlled environment. This approach minimizes risk and provides valuable feedback that can be used to improve the system before it is fully deployed.

Question 12: What role should leadership play in the AI adoption journey?

A. A leading role in providing a clear vision, securing resources, and championing the project.

B. A passive role, allowing the technical team to handle everything.

C. A supervisory role, checking in only at the end of the project.

D. No role at all, as AI is a purely technical matter.

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: Leadership is critical for the success of any major initiative. They must provide the strategic vision, allocate the necessary resources, and communicate the importance of the project to the entire organization.

Question 13: After an AI solution is fully deployed, what is the next important step for a business owner?

A. To forget about the project and start a new one.

B. To fire the project team since their work is done.

C. To continuously monitor its performance and provide ongoing maintenance and improvement.

D. To declare the project a complete success and never look at it again.

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: AI solutions require continuous monitoring and maintenance to ensure they continue to perform effectively. This includes updating the model with new data and making adjustments as business needs evolve.

Curated YouTube Videos

1. **Title:** The 7 steps of machine learning
Channel: Google Cloud Tech

This video explains the seven steps of machine learning using the example of creating a system to differentiate between wine and beer. The steps are: gathering data, data preparation, choosing a model, training, evaluation, hyperparameter tuning, and prediction/inference. The video highlights that machine learning can be applied to solve business problems and automate tasks, and that the quality and quantity of data are crucial for building effective models.

A business owner should watch this video to understand the fundamental concepts and processes of machine learning. This knowledge can help them identify opportunities to use data to gain insights, have more informed discussions with data scientists, and make better decisions regarding the adoption of machine learning in their business.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nKW8Ndu7Mjw>.

2. **Title:** How to Drive AI Adoption Internally
Channel: Boston Consulting Group

This video discusses how to drive AI adoption within an organization by using both a top-down and a bottom-up approach. It highlights the importance of creating a tailored program that generates excitement among employees, using a combination of incentives and progress tracking. The speakers also express excitement about the future of agent technology, particularly its ability to perform collaborative actions.

A business owner should watch this video to gain practical strategies for AI adoption, learn how to balance leadership direction with grassroots engagement, and understand how a well-structured incentive and tracking system can motivate employees.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hd6L4DRWgvY>.

3. **Title:** The AI adoption playbook: Lessons from Microsoft's internal strategy
Channel: DX

This video discusses strategies for driving the adoption of AI software development assistants within organizations, drawing on insights from Microsoft's internal experiences. It highlights key strategies such as strong leadership advocacy, formal training, and identifying local champions to share positive experiences. It also covers the importance of managing expectations, proactively addressing developer concerns, and tracking adoption with data.

A business owner should watch this video to learn about common adoption challenges and get actionable strategies to increase the successful integration of AI tools. It emphasizes the

importance of setting realistic expectations, measuring impact, and fostering a culture that embraces new technologies, which is crucial for maintaining a competitive edge.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=c51ToE4pPpY>.

4. **Title:** Everything You NEED to Know About TECH DEBT
Channel: ForrestKnight

This video provides a comprehensive overview of technical debt, explaining it as shortcuts taken in code that slow down development in the long run. It categorizes technical debt into four quadrants (deliberate/prudent, deliberate/reckless, inadvertent/prudent, and inadvertent/reckless) and draws a parallel to financial debt, where the "interest" is the extra time spent working around or fixing poorly written code.

A business owner should watch this video because it explains how technical debt directly impacts the business's bottom line and agility. The video highlights that teams can spend a significant portion of their time dealing with technical debt, which slows down the release of new features. It provides strategies for managing and measuring technical debt, such as allocating a percentage of time to fixing it, and offers methods to communicate its impact to stakeholders using data. Understanding these concepts can help a business owner make informed decisions about resource allocation, mitigate long-term financial burdens, and prevent future problems.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ukgmp6uxQJc>.

5. **Title:** Don't Lead A Data Team Before Watching This - 5 Lessons You Need To Know As A Head of Data
Channel: Seattle Data Guy

This video offers advice for data professionals transitioning into leadership roles, such as Head of Data or Director. It highlights five key lessons: focusing on business outcomes over technology, being intentional with team roles, prioritizing data quality, simplifying infrastructure, and understanding the core business.

A business owner should watch this video to gain insight into the challenges of managing a data team and to set realistic expectations for data initiatives. By understanding the video's lessons, a business owner can improve communication with their data leaders, better appreciate the importance of data quality, and recognize how a well-led data team can become a strategic business partner.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=n74ke0Wjmi4>.

6. **Title:** 4 Steps to Validating Your Software Proof of Concept
Channel: Crema

This video explains the four steps to validating a software proof of concept (POC). It defines a POC as a document that explores the technical feasibility of a potential solution and its business impact. The four steps are:

1. Prove the Need for Your Concept: Define your target audience and the problem you're solving for them by conducting interviews and looking for patterns.
2. Brainstorm Solutions: Develop multiple solutions and get feedback from your target audience to decide which to move forward with.
3. Validate Your POC with a Prototype: Create and test a basic prototype with users in a controlled environment to assess intuitiveness and identify missing features.
4. Evaluate the Results: Determine if your POC was successful based on the criteria you set at the beginning and the feedback you gathered to decide if the product is worth continuing.

A business owner should watch this video because it provides a clear, step-by-step process for validating a software idea before investing significant time and money into full-scale development. Following these steps helps reduce risk, ensures there's a real market need for the product, and helps the owner make informed decisions about resource allocation.

The video can be found at http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LBvoZM7s_es.

Supplementary Materials

[<Step-by-Step Guide: The AI Adoption Journey for Business Owners>](#)

[<AI Tools Directory>](#)

[<ROI Calculator - AI Success Blueprint User Guide>](#)

Module 3: Using AI Responsibly - Ethical & Governance Principles

Why this Module

Module 3 addresses the most significant risks associated with AI adoption: ethical and legal challenges. By focusing on this early in the journey, we're equipping our participants to build trust and prevent costly mistakes before they happen, including anticipating and designing solutions to tackle foreseeable challenges.

The key points to cover are the core principles of Fairness and Bias, Transparency, and Accountability. You will explain why these aren't just abstract concepts, but practical considerations that directly impact a business's reputation and legal standing. You will also cover the importance of establishing a simple AI Governance framework. These topics are crucial because they empower business owners to not only choose the right AI tools but to implement them in a way that is ethical, compliant, and sustainable, protecting both the business and its customers.

Thought-provoking Questions

1. Imagine you use an AI tool to screen job applicants. The tool begins consistently recommending male candidates over female candidates, even with similar qualifications. How would you investigate the source of this bias, and what specific steps would you take to ensure fairness and prevent reputational damage to your business?
2. Your company uses an AI chatbot for customer service. One day, a customer complains that the bot gave them an incorrect but plausible-sounding solution, leading to a loss of time and money. Who in your organization is ultimately accountable for that error, and how would you establish a clear chain of human oversight to prevent it from happening again?
3. An AI marketing tool you use suggests a campaign that, while highly effective, is ethically questionable in its targeting. What is your decision-making process for determining whether to proceed? Who would you consult with, and what ethical principles would you prioritize to guide your choice?

Suggested Quiz (Individual Assignment)

Question 1: Why is it crucial for a business owner to consider the "Fairness and Non-Discrimination" principle when implementing an AI system?

A. To prevent the AI from making decisions that could unfairly discriminate against certain

groups of people.

- B. To ensure the AI system only makes decisions that benefit the company's bottom line.
- C. To make the AI system more complex and difficult to understand.
- D. To guarantee that the AI system will never make a mistake.

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: Fairness and Non-Discrimination is an essential ethical principle because AI systems, if trained on biased data, can perpetuate and amplify existing societal biases, leading to discriminatory outcomes in areas like hiring, loan approvals, or customer service.

Question 2: What is the primary purpose of "AI Governance" for a business?

- A. To create a complex set of rules that slows down innovation.
- B. To establish a framework of policies and procedures to ensure AI is used safely and ethically.
- C. To prevent any employee from using AI tools.
- D. To make sure the company is always the first to adopt new AI technology.

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: AI governance provides the structure and guidelines for responsible AI adoption. It helps ensure that AI systems are developed and used in a way that aligns with the company's values, legal requirements, and ethical standards.

Question 3: As a business owner, what does the ethical principle of "Transparency and Explainability" mean for your AI projects?

- A. That you must reveal your company's entire business strategy to the public.
- B. That the AI system must be so simple that everyone can build it.
- C. That the AI system's decision-making process should be understandable and its actions justifiable.
- D. That all of the AI's data should be made public.

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: Transparency and Explainability ensure that the reasoning behind an AI's decision is not a "black box." Business owners should be able to explain how an AI system arrived at a conclusion, which is crucial for building trust with customers and stakeholders.

Question 4: What is the potential risk of using an AI system that lacks "Accountability"?

- A. The AI system might become sentient and start making its own decisions.
- B. The AI system will be too slow and inefficient.
- C. The company could face legal and reputational damage if the AI causes harm and no one is held responsible.
- D. The company will be forced to use only open-source AI tools.

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: Accountability ensures that there is a clear chain of responsibility for an AI system's actions. Without it, a business can face significant legal and public relations challenges if the AI makes a harmful or unethical decision.

Question 5: A business owner is concerned about the "Privacy and Security" of their customer information. What is a key step they should take when using AI?

- A. Use as much customer data as possible, without their consent.
- B. Store all customer data in an unencrypted format.
- C. Share all customer data with third-party partners.
- D. Anonymize data where possible and only use data that is essential for the AI's function.

Correct Answer: D

Explanation: The principle of privacy and data protection requires business owners to be responsible custodians of data. Key actions include minimizing the data collected, anonymizing it where appropriate, and ensuring it is securely stored to prevent misuse.

Question 6: What is "Algorithmic Bias" and why should business owners be concerned about it?

- A. It's a new type of computer virus that only affects AI systems.

- B. It's a term for a complex mathematical formula used in AI.
- C. It's the process of making an AI system more accurate.
- D. It occurs when an algorithm favors one group over another, which can lead to unfair or discriminatory outcomes.

Correct Answer: D

Explanation: Algorithmic bias can arise from biased training data or flawed algorithms. It is a critical concern for business owners because it can lead to inequitable decisions and damage a company's reputation and relationships with its customers.

Question 7: Which of the following is a key element of establishing a strong AI governance framework?

- A. Creating a new department to manage all of the company's technical equipment.
- B. Implementing a committee or team responsible for overseeing the ethical use of AI.
- C. Mandating that all employees learn to code.
- D. Completely outsourcing all AI projects to external vendors.

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: A key element of AI governance is the establishment of a dedicated group or committee to review AI projects, set ethical guidelines, and ensure compliance with policies.

Question 8: What is a good practice for a business owner to ensure their AI system is "Robust and Secure"?

- A. Conduct regular audits and testing to protect against data breaches and system failures.
- B. Ensure the system is completely open to the public for feedback.
- C. Use the AI system without any security measures.
- D. Assume the AI system will never be attacked.

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: Robustness and security are critical for trustworthy AI. This involves actively testing the system's defenses against potential attacks and vulnerabilities, which helps to ensure the system is reliable and safe.

Question 9: Why is it important to have "Human Oversight" in AI decision-making?

- A. To prevent the AI from ever making a decision on its own.
- B. To ensure that humans can intervene and override an AI's decision if it is incorrect or unethical.
- C. To slow down the decision-making process.
- D. To give employees a task to do that the AI cannot perform.

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Human oversight provides a critical safety net. It allows for a human to review and, if necessary, correct or overrule an AI's decision, especially in high-stakes situations.

Question 10: A business owner has implemented an AI system for hiring that is unknowingly biased against certain demographics. What is the most likely consequence?

- A. Increased employee satisfaction and morale.
- B. The company will attract a more diverse workforce.
- C. Legal challenges, reputational damage, and a less diverse and potentially less effective workforce.
- D. A significant increase in company profits.

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: Algorithmic bias in hiring can lead to a lack of diversity, legal issues, and a tarnished company image. It's a prime example of the negative business consequences of failing to address ethical principles.

Question 11: Why should a business owner be concerned with the "Data Privacy" of their customers when using AI?

- A. It is a legal requirement in many regions and builds customer trust.
- B. It is not a concern as AI systems are inherently secure.

- C. It will make the AI system more powerful.
- D. It helps to simplify the AI's programming.

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: Data privacy is not only an ethical concern but also a legal one, with regulations like GDPR and CCPA. Adhering to these rules and protecting customer data builds trust and avoids significant legal and financial penalties.

Question 12: What is the primary risk of not having a clear "AI Governance" structure in place?

- A. The company will never be able to use AI.
- B. The company may unintentionally use AI in an unethical or non-compliant way, leading to harm and legal issues.
- C. The AI system will work too well.
- D. The company will have too many employees.

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Without proper governance, there is a significant risk that a business may use AI without considering its ethical implications, leading to unintended harm, data breaches, and non-compliance with regulations.

Curated YouTube Videos

1. **Title:** Managing the risks of AI
Channel: University of Technology Sydney

This video outlines the multifaceted risks associated with implementing AI systems in a business context. It categorizes these risks into three main areas: Commercial, which includes potential financial losses and security vulnerabilities from poor AI performance; Reputational, which arises from ethical failures like biased results that can damage brand trust; and Regulatory, which involves legal consequences for violating existing laws on data privacy, consumer rights, or employee safety. The video uses an example of a medical AI system to show how these risks can overlap and emphasizes the importance of a human-centered approach to risk management.

A business owner should watch this video to understand the significant and multifaceted risks that come with implementing AI technologies. It provides a clear framework for thinking about potential downsides beyond just technical failures, including financial losses, damage to the company's image, and serious legal consequences. By understanding these risks, business

owners can proactively develop strategies to ensure they are using AI responsibly and ethically, thereby protecting their stakeholders and their organization. The video emphasizes the importance of foresight and considering potential harms before they materialize, which is crucial for any leader looking to leverage AI successfully.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mt8QV8LGI5o>.

2. **Title:** Addressing AI system harms

Channel: University of Technology Sydney

This video discusses the potential harms of AI systems, categorizing them into three sources: systems that fail to perform as expected (e.g., due to bias or security flaws), those that are deliberately misused (e.g., for privacy invasion), and those that have unintended negative societal impacts (e.g., energy consumption). The video emphasizes that as AI adoption increases, so do the associated risks.

A business owner should watch this video to understand the critical importance of anticipating and addressing the potential harms of AI. The video provides a clear framework for thinking about risks that can lead to legal, financial, and reputational damage. By proactively considering how their AI systems could fail, be misused, or have unintended consequences, business owners can develop robust strategies to ensure responsible use of the technology and protect their organization.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5RqloSorFF0>.

3. **Title:** What are the Essential Components of an AI Governance Framework?

Channel: Insight Jam

This video is a panel discussion that outlines the essential components of an AI governance framework for businesses. It emphasizes that a robust framework must be built on a foundation of strong data governance, with clear documentation of which models are used for what purposes. The video highlights the importance of transparency, ethical use, and accountability to build trust and mitigate risks. It also stresses the need to understand how AI is being used across the organization and by third-party vendors to ensure compliance and manage potential harms.

A business owner should watch this video because it provides a concise guide for safely and effectively adopting AI. By understanding the key components of an AI governance framework, a business owner can proactively mitigate significant risks, including financial losses, reputational damage, and legal penalties. The video's insights on transparency and accountability can help build trust with customers and stakeholders, while its emphasis on compliance prepares the business for an evolving regulatory landscape. It encourages a strategic approach to AI that balances innovation with responsible use, which is crucial for long-term success.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mXUvbPmL4so>.

4. **Title:** The Five Must-Haves of an AI Governance Framework
Channel: SANS Institute

This video discusses the critical need for an AI governance framework within businesses. It highlights the significant risks of ungoverned AI through real-world examples of company failures, which led to financial losses and reputational damage. The video outlines five essential components of a robust framework: a comprehensive AI model inventory, a two-tiered AI risk management approach, thorough data governance, continuous model verification and validation, and post-deployment monitoring of AI systems. It also emphasizes the importance of leadership support and a cross-functional team approach to successfully integrate AI governance into a company's culture.

A business owner should watch this video to understand the necessity of proactively establishing an AI governance framework, which is crucial for mitigating risks and ensuring compliance in an evolving regulatory landscape. The video provides a clear and practical guide on how to avoid the common pitfalls and failures experienced by other companies, thereby protecting the business from significant financial and reputational harm. By understanding the five key components, a business owner can build a trustworthy and reliable AI system that aligns with their company's strategic objectives and long-term success.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NrkJLbn3dDE> .

Supplementary Materials

[<Checklist: How to Reduce Bias in Your Data>](#)

[<Step-by-Step Guide: Building Your AI Governance Framework>](#)

[<Generic Privacy & Data Usage Policy Sample>](#)

[<AI Project Risk Scorecard>](#)

Module 4: Key Considerations & Framework for Successful AI Deployment

Why this Module

Module 4 is designed to equip our participants with the strategic foresight needed to guide business owners through the complexities of AI beyond the initial project. While previous modules focused on the “why”, “what”, and “how,” this one is about anticipating and mitigating broader risks.

You will cover the importance of staying current with the evolving legal and regulatory landscape, as this is crucial for ensuring a business remains compliant and avoids legal pitfalls. You will also address the human element by providing a framework for workforce impact, including upskilling and change management, which is vital for securing employee buy-in and a smooth transition. Furthermore, you will guide participants on measuring both the tangible and intangible ROI of AI initiatives, ensuring business owners can effectively justify their investments. By addressing these critical areas, this module ensures that AI is not just implemented but successfully integrated as a core component of their long-term business strategy, cementing the change and bringing it to a BAU phase! This creates the momentum to build up further AI initiatives in business organizations.

Thought-provoking Questions

1. Many AI projects focus on cost savings or efficiency. Beyond those, what is one non-financial metric—like employee morale, brand reputation, or customer loyalty—that you would want to measure to determine the true success of an AI deployment, and how would you go about measuring it?
2. Imagine a new regulation is passed that makes the AI tool your business relies on for a key function non-compliant. What is your immediate and long-term plan to pivot, and how would you build a framework to anticipate and prepare for future regulatory changes?
3. Consider a specific job role in your company that you believe will be significantly impacted by AI. Instead of thinking about replacing that person, how would you redesign their role to focus on human-centric skills (e.g., creativity, empathy, strategic thinking), and what AI tools would you provide to assist them?
4. When deciding between a pre-built AI solution with a fast, measurable ROI and building a custom solution with a potentially higher but longer-term ROI, what are the three most critical factors you would weigh to make the right decision for your business's future?
5. If you begin using AI to generate marketing content, what specific policies would you put in place to ensure the content is factually accurate, legally sound (e.g., no copyright infringement), and transparently labeled as AI-generated to maintain trust with your audience?

Suggested Quiz (Individual Assignment)

Question 1: What is a key step in building a successful AI deployment framework?

- A. Hiring a single data scientist to handle all aspects of the project.
- B. Creating a detailed AI strategy that aligns with overall business goals.
- C. Implementing the most expensive AI technology available, regardless of cost.
- D. Avoiding communication with employees about the changes.

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: A successful AI deployment is built on a clear strategy that aligns with the company's business goals. This ensures the project is relevant, provides value, and has the support of key stakeholders.

Question 2: What is the primary role of "change management" in an AI deployment?

- A. To change the AI's code every day to keep it fresh.
- B. To change the company's logo and branding.
- C. To manage the financial budget of the project.
- D. To manage the human side of the transition, including employee training and communication.

Correct Answer: D

Explanation: Change management focuses on preparing, equipping, and supporting individuals through a change. In AI deployment, this means ensuring employees understand the new systems, are trained on how to use them, and are comfortable with the transition.

Question 3: Why is it important to measure the ROI (Return on Investment) of an AI project?

- A. To prove that the project was a waste of money.
- B. To determine how much more money can be spent.
- C. To confuse the finance department with complex metrics.
- D. To justify the investment and show the value the AI solution is bringing to the business.

Correct Answer: D

Explanation: Measuring ROI is essential for justifying the project to stakeholders and proving its success. It demonstrates that the AI solution is delivering a tangible, positive impact on the business.

Question 4: What does the term "AI Maturity" refer to in the context of a business?

- A. The age of the company's IT systems.
- B. The company's level of readiness and capability to implement and scale AI.
- C. How many different AI tools the company has purchased.
- D. The number of employees who have a degree in computer science.

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: AI maturity is a measure of a company's readiness to adopt and scale AI, including its data infrastructure, technical skills, and organizational culture.

Question 5: What is a crucial aspect of "post-implementation" support for a newly deployed AI system?

- A. Removing the AI system entirely after it's been launched.
- B. Providing ongoing training, technical support, and monitoring to ensure the system remains effective.
- C. Telling employees they are on their own to figure it out.
- D. Firing the project team once the AI is live.

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Post-implementation support is vital for the long-term success of an AI solution. This includes continuous monitoring for performance, providing user support, and making necessary updates and improvements.

Question 6: What is a key legal and regulatory consideration a business owner must address when deploying an AI system?

- A. How to ensure the AI system complies with data privacy laws like GDPR or CCPA.

- B. How to make the AI system more profitable.
- C. How to get the AI system to write its own legal documents.
- D. How to avoid paying taxes on the AI system.

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: Legal and regulatory compliance, especially regarding data privacy, is a critical consideration. Business owners must ensure their AI systems are designed to handle data in a way that aligns with regional and international laws to avoid legal penalties and build customer trust.

Question 7: When deploying an AI solution, what is the best approach to manage its impact on the company's workforce?

- A. To keep the AI project a secret until it is fully launched.
- B. To only hire new employees who are already AI experts.
- C. To clearly communicate how the AI will augment employee capabilities and provide training opportunities.
- D. To immediately downsize the workforce to save money.

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: A proactive approach to managing workforce impact involves transparent communication. By explaining how AI will complement human skills and offering training, business owners can ease employee concerns and facilitate a smoother transition.

Question 8: What is a significant risk of non-compliance with AI-related regulations?

- A. The AI system will work too slowly.
- B. The company will be unable to purchase any more AI software.
- C. The company could face significant fines, legal action, and reputational damage.
- D. The AI system will stop working permanently.

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: Non-compliance with legal and regulatory frameworks can lead to serious consequences, including heavy financial penalties, lawsuits from affected parties, and a loss of public trust in the brand.

Question 9: In the context of workforce impact, what is the benefit of "upskilling" employees during an AI deployment?

- A. It helps employees develop new skills to work alongside the AI, increasing their value and job satisfaction.
- B. It makes employees feel less important to the company.
- C. It is an expensive and unnecessary step.
- D. It forces employees to leave the company on their own.

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: Upskilling and reskilling employees to work with AI tools turns a potential threat into an opportunity. It empowers the workforce to handle higher-value tasks, increasing overall productivity and employee engagement.

Question 10: What does it mean for a business owner to "champion" the AI initiative when considering workforce impact?

- A. To delegate all communication about the AI to the IT department.
- B. To blame the AI system when something goes wrong.
- C. To not get involved in the project at all.
- D. To actively promote the project's benefits and provide a clear vision for how AI will enhance the company.

Correct Answer: D

Explanation: A champion is an advocate for the project. By actively leading the initiative and communicating a positive vision, a business owner can build trust, foster a culture of innovation, and ensure employee support for the AI deployment.

Curated YouTube Videos

1. **Title:** How to compute the ROI on AI projects?

Channel: Dr. Raj Ramesh

This video explains how to calculate the return on investment (ROI) for AI projects. It uses the example of a drone-based system for assessing hail damage to illustrate the benefits and costs involved.

A business owner should watch this video because it provides a structured framework for thinking about AI project ROI. It highlights unique considerations for AI projects, such as data gathering, model maintenance, and the need for cross-functional teams. The video also offers best practices for implementing AI, emphasizing customer experience, setting realistic expectations, and starting with pilot projects.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1JPifm2tHGM>.

2. **Title:** ISO 42001 Explained: The New AI Governance Standard & What It Means for Your Business Channel: First Focus Insights

This video features an expert explaining the new AI governance standard, **ISO 42001**. The standard is designed to help organizations manage the risks and ethical considerations of using AI, and it can be integrated with existing standards like ISO 27001 for data governance. The discussion covers the types of risks the standard helps mitigate, the process and cost of certification, and practical steps for implementation, such as appointing an AI champion and building a diverse oversight team.

A business owner should watch this video to understand the growing importance of formal AI governance. By learning about the new ISO 42001 standard, a business owner can proactively manage the risks and ethical considerations associated with AI, which can protect the company from legal, financial, and reputational damage. The video provides a clear roadmap for implementing a robust AI governance framework, which is crucial for any business seeking to use AI responsibly and effectively.

The video can be found at http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VS_pC-JZv28.

3. **Title:** AI Deployment for Enterprise Success: Leadership Strategies That Work Channel: Enterprise Transformation & AI with Rob Llewellyn

This video discusses three key pillars for a successful AI implementation within a business: building a strong data foundation, crafting a scalable architecture, and achieving operational excellence through continuous monitoring. It also highlights common pitfalls to avoid, such as underestimating organizational resistance and the importance of a clear business outcome from the pilot phase.

A business owner should watch this video to understand the critical components of a successful AI deployment, which go beyond just the technology itself. By focusing on a robust data foundation and a scalable architecture, a business can mitigate common pitfalls and ensure their AI initiatives deliver meaningful business outcomes. The video emphasizes that AI is not a one-time project but an ongoing process that requires continuous monitoring and leadership strategies to succeed.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wet0UoZt0yM>.

4. **Title:** Where Is AI Delivering ROI?

Channel: Forbes

This video is a panel discussion among experts about the transformative potential of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and its practical applications in business. The panel believes AI will be a creative force more significant than the internet, capable of producing skills and intelligence. They discuss how AI is being used in traditional service businesses like accounting and IT to increase productivity and address supply-demand imbalances, and they also highlight the importance of due diligence for investors in the AI space.

The discussion covers both the exciting opportunities of AI (e.g., climate change solutions, drug development) and the significant risks (e.g., job displacement, misuse for bioweapons). They emphasize that integrating AI requires careful change management to get buy-in from employees and that the current challenge is not just in developing the core AI but in building products and processes to effectively harness it.

A business owner should watch this video to gain a clear understanding of the transformative potential of AI and its practical applications. The discussion provides real-world examples of how AI is being used in traditional businesses to boost productivity and cut costs. By watching, a business owner can learn what investors are looking for in AI companies, anticipate future trends, and better prepare their workforce for the changes AI will bring. The video offers a balanced perspective on both the opportunities and the significant challenges of implementing AI, helping business owners make more informed and strategic decisions.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8HeWmPVPh8w>.

5. **Title:** From pilot to production: Driving ROI with genAI

Channel: IBM Technology

This video from IBM Technology discusses how businesses can move beyond the experimental phase of generative AI (GenAI) and scale it to create real value. It highlights key opportunity areas for scaling GenAI, such as improving productivity, enhancing customer experience, creating new revenue streams, and optimizing IT. The video also provides a roadmap for driving

GenAI change in an organization, including defining a strategy, focusing on ROI, building an AI control center, and fostering a GenAI-forward culture.

A business owner should watch this video to move beyond the hype of GenAI and find a practical framework for implementation and scaling. It offers insights on how to deliver ROI through GenAI, guidance on building the necessary infrastructure, and a focus on empowering employees, helping them gain a significant, sustainable business advantage.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FtYKoDomUp8>.

6. **Title:** Calculating the Cost and ROI of Generative AI | Amazon Web Services
Channel: Amazon Web Services

This video podcast from AWS discusses the cost and value of generative AI. It covers understanding the different components of cost, such as the choice of model and talent, and provides advice on how to estimate and minimize costs. It also explores how to realize the value of generative AI through productivity gains, enhanced customer experience, and new revenue streams.

A business owner should watch this video to gain a practical understanding of how to approach generative AI strategically. It offers actionable advice on cost management, value identification, and strategic implementation, which is crucial for managing risk and building a compelling business case for investment.

The video can be found at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5uKFszLtnjl>.

Supplementary Materials

[<Framework for Successful Enterprise AI Deployment>](#)

[<Market Overview Research Report: 10 ASEAN States>](#)

[<ROI Calculator - AI Success Blueprint User Guide>](#)

Module 5: Advanced Data Management & Governance for AI

Module 5 is included as an **optional** module to offer a deeper dive into data management and governance, which is foundational for businesses looking to scale their AI efforts effectively. While not every business owner will require this level of detail at the outset, it's a "good to have" for those who are more advanced in their digital transformation journey or are in industries with strict data regulations.

The main points to cover are the data lifecycle, the core principles of data governance, and the importance of data privacy regulations like the PDPA. We've included this module so that local implementation partners can tailor the program to their specific communities. For regions where businesses are more mature digitally or face stricter compliance requirements, this module will be invaluable for ensuring that their AI projects are not only successful but also secure and legally compliant. By mastering these concepts, business owners can build a robust data foundation that supports ethical and scalable AI implementation. It can also help business owners to build robust processes, to secure their clients' data, and gain their trust.

Module 6: Building an AI-Ready Culture & Workforce Transformation

Module 6 is an essential **optional** module that shifts the focus from technology to the human element, a critical yet often overlooked component of successful AI adoption. We've included this module so that our local implementation partners can address the soft skills and cultural changes necessary for AI to thrive within an organization. It is particularly useful for businesses that are looking to move beyond simple pilot projects and truly integrate AI into their long-term strategy.

The key points to cover are strategies for fostering an AI-ready culture, which include encouraging experimentation and continuous learning. You will also address the impact of AI on the workforce, to get business owners to plan for upskilling and reskilling employees to work alongside AI. Lastly, you will focus on effective change management techniques to help businesses minimize resistance and ensure a smooth transition. By offering this module, you empower business owners to view AI not as a replacement for their people but as a catalyst for a more innovative and capable workforce, creating communities that thrive together.

Module 7: AI Project Risk Management & Mitigation

This module designed as an **optional** but highly valuable addition for local implementation partners who want to provide a comprehensive roadmap for long-term AI success. The goal is to move beyond simply building an AI project to building a resilient and secure one. It is particularly relevant for businesses that are dealing with sensitive data, operating in regulated industries, or planning a significant AI investment.

The key points to cover are the various types of risks associated with AI projects, from technical and security risks to ethical and reputational ones. You will guide business owners on how to proactively identify, assess, and prioritize these risks. You will also focus on practical mitigation strategies across the entire project lifecycle, emphasizing the importance of robust data quality, continuous monitoring, and human oversight. By offering this module, you empower business owners to protect their investments and their reputations, ensuring that their AI initiatives are not only innovative but also sustainable and secure. This can lead to continuous adoption and adaptation of AI in the organization, allowing AI to power the local economy through business and jobs.

Local Implementation Guidelines

As there are different circumstances between the ASEAN countries, for instance, education level, technology and digital literacy level, political systems, etc and such, the suggested modules and respective learning objectives will just serve as the backbone of the whole program. The AIM ASEAN program will need the Local Implementation Partners to take advantage of their familiarity with the respective individual ASEAN countries to adapt the curriculum for local circumstances, to increase engagement and knowledge transfer. Some considerations to make will be:

1. Education Level
2. Technology & Digital Literacy Level
3. Adult Training Industry Maturity Level
4. Digital Transformation Maturity Level
5. Existing Industry and Economic Sector in the respective countries
6. Technology Skills Level of Manpower

You may refer to this [<Market Overview Research Report: 10 ASEAN Member States>](#) for some context for your respective member state.

Below are suggestions on how Local Implementation Partners can increase engagement and knowledge transfer. This can be done in the following way:

1. Mode of Delivery (Lecture, Group Discussion, Polls)
2. Class Activities - Inclusive of Discussion Questions
3. Use Cases & Examples
4. MCQ Question Bank

Reminder: In the Curriculum Outline, the amount of time to cover each subtopic is indicated as a guide on how much content to add. It is a suggestion, and Local Implementation Partners should adjust the content and the rate of delivery according to circumstances like time of day, whether it is delivered online or offline, etc. More importantly, it is to ensure that the participants are still receptive to new knowledge, able to have the bandwidth to process and understand the content, and be able to bring this knowledge back to their businesses.

Suggested Mode of Delivery

1. Short, Practical Sessions (30–60 Minutes Per Session)

Each session is designed to be bite-sized and laser-focused on a specific business problem or task that a Micro SME owner or staff member can implement immediately.

To accommodate different learning styles and experience levels, each module *is suggested to be delivered* in two tiers:

- Beginner: Introduction to key concepts with a live or recorded demonstration
- Doer: Guided, hands-on practice that results in a tangible business output

Advantage: *Conducting in this manner can help participants to quickly get feedback on what they have learned, how to apply it, and adjust their knowledge accordingly through the hands-on practice.*

Disadvantage: *Conducting this hands-on exercise, the length of the workshop will depend on how fast every participant can work through the hands-on exercise, step-by-step.*

2. Live Demo-Based Training with Real Tools (Flexible Delivery)

To suit the diverse schedules and digital capabilities of MSMEs, tool demonstrations can be delivered through a combination of recorded content, documentation, and optional live engagement opportunities.

a. Recorded Video Demonstrations

- Pre-recorded, step-by-step video tutorials showcasing practical tasks using tools such as Google Sheets, Gemini, Google Forms, Canva, and others
- Videos can be short (5–10 minutes per task) and are designed for both desktop and mobile users
- MSMEs can pause and revisit videos at their convenience, supporting self-paced learning

b. Documentation with Screenshots and Guides

- Each video and module can be supported with simple, illustrated how-to documents with annotated screenshots
- Documentation can include setup instructions, common use cases, best practices, and troubleshooting tips
- Most materials are provided in editable formats to allow easy localisation by country partners

c. Q&A Sessions with Experts or Tool Vendors (Optional)

- Live or pre-recorded Q&A sessions can be arranged with tool experts or certified trainers (e.g., Google or Canva representatives)
- Formats can include monthly AMA (Ask-Me-Anything) sessions, panel-style discussions, or MSME case-sharing webinars

d. Self-Guided Practice Activities

- After each demonstration (selected tools), participants can be given practical checklists and exercises to apply the tools to their real business scenarios
- Trainers may encourage sharing outcomes within local groups or chat forums to build community learning

e. Sector-Specific Adaptation Guidance

- Local trainers can be supported with guidance on tailoring demos to local industries, ensuring examples are relevant and relatable
- You may refer to the AI Use Cases for references

Advantage: *Conducting in this manner can suit the learning velocity of each participant, through self-service. There can be consistent engagement, since participants are learn at their own velocity.*

Disadvantage: *There is no immediate feedback from the trainer, and mistakes or misunderstandings may not be caught upfront easily.*

3. Worksheets and Cheat Sheets with Screenshots

Each module can include printable and downloadable worksheets to reinforce learning. These may include (some have been provided in the [Resources Hub](#)):

- Business-focused worksheets (e.g., “My AI Marketing Plan,” “Prompt Writing Practice,” “Automation Planner”)
- Cheat sheets featuring step-by-step screenshots and tool interface annotations for less tech-savvy participants
- Mobile and desktop-friendly formats can be offered, with localised screenshots where appropriate

Advantage: *Conducting in this manner can suit the learning velocity of each participant, through self-service. There can be consistent engagement, since participants are learn at their own velocity.*

Disadvantage: *There is no immediate feedback from the trainer, and mistakes or misunderstandings may not be caught upfront easily. Participants may not know the thought*

process behind how the worksheets are designed, the learning objectives and be able to adopt the knowledge.

4. Downloadable Templates (Ready-to-Use)

Participants can receive access to a library of practical, editable templates that they can duplicate and customise for their business needs. Templates include:

- Social media caption templates in multiple tones and local languages
- Product description builders (e.g., [Problem] + [Solution] + [Why You])
- WhatsApp message templates for order confirmations and customer support
- Simple invoice, tracker, and inventory sheets (Google Sheets format)
- [AI prompt library](#) categorised by use case (e.g., marketing, admin, planning)
- All templates will be designed to work within Google Workspace for ease of use and accessibility across devices.

Advantage: *Conducting in this manner can suit the learning velocity of each participant, through self-service. There can be consistent engagement, since participants are learn at their own velocity.*

Disadvantage: *There is no immediate feedback from the trainer, and mistakes or misunderstandings may not be caught upfront easily. Participants may not know the thought process behind how the worksheets are designed, the learning objectives and be able to adopt the knowledge.*

Note: These are just suggestions. Local Implementation Partners are to adopt and adapt them according to local circumstances, for maximum engagement and knowledge transfer.

Guidelines for Using Curated YouTube Videos in Training Materials

To ensure that we respect intellectual property rights and comply with YouTube's [Terms of Service](#), please follow the guidelines below when using the curated YouTube videos we have recommended:

1. Use Videos Fairly and Legally

- Only use YouTube videos **for educational purposes** in line with **fair use/fair dealing principles**.
- Avoid downloading videos using converters or screen recording tools **unless you have obtained explicit permission or the video is licensed for such use**.

2. Embed Instead of Download

- Always **embed** the video directly from YouTube into your presentation, Learning Management System (LMS), or slide deck using YouTube's official embed function.
- **Do not** download, alter, or re-upload the video into your own materials unless you have the proper licensing or rights from the original creator.

3. Attribute the Creator Properly

Whenever a YouTube video is used, **credit the original creator**. Include the following information where possible:

- **Name** of the creator or channel
- **Video Title**
- **Link** to the original YouTube video
- **License**, if specified (e.g., Creative Commons)

Summary of Useful Links

[<Detailed Curriculum>](#)

[<Resources Hub>](#)

[<Use Case Feasibility Checklist>](#)

[<AI Prompt Library>](#)

[<AI Prompt Design Worksheet>](#)

[<AI Use Cases>](#)

[<Step-by-Step Guide: The AI Adoption Journey for Business Owners>](#)

[<AI Tools Directory>](#)

[<Checklist: How to Reduce Bias in Your Data>](#)

[<Step-by-Step Guide: Building Your AI Governance Framework>](#)

[<Framework for Successful Enterprise AI Deployment>](#)

[<Market Overview Research Report: 10 ASEAN States>](#)

[<Generic Privacy & Data Usage Policy Sample>](#)

[<AI Project Risk Scorecard>](#)

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Your feedback is important to us! Please share your thoughts and suggestions to help us improve the Facilitator Guide. Reach us at aimaseanfoundation@gmail.com

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